Write Hebrew by hand: cursive words

Israelis write by hand in **ktav yad** (cursive), which looks different from the printed letters you read. This workbook gives every one of the 27 letter forms (22 letters and 5 final forms) a handwriting row and up to three real words to copy, in alphabet order.

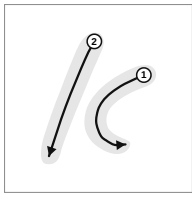
How to use it

1. Look at the stroke box: the numbered circle is where a stroke starts, the arrowhead where it ends.
2. Trace the letter row from the **right**: solid, then grey, then dotted, then write it alone.
3. Each word row shows the pointed printed word (how you read it), its sound and meaning, then the handwritten word to trace. Handwriting is usually written **without** vowel signs, so the traced word has none.
4. Tick the box when you can write the word without looking.

DRAFT: cursive stroke order not reviewed by a native writer; words from the course data, not teacher-checked. Cursive shapes come from the font Gveret Levin (SIL OFL 1.1); real handwriting joins and varies. Words marked * have a machine-made transliteration (Israeli, siddur style) that no native speaker has checked. Every letter form has at least one word.

Contents

1. Alef (3) · 2. Bet (3) · 3. Gimel (3) · 4. Dalet (2) · 5. He (3) · 6. Vav (3) · 7. Zayin (3) · 8. Chet (3) · 9. Tet (3) · 10. Yod (3) · 11. Kaf (3) · 12. Lamed (3) · 13. Mem (3) · 14. Nun (3) · 15. Samekh (3) · 16. Ayin (3) · 17. Pe (3) · 18. Tsadi (2) · 19. Qof (3) · 20. Resh (3) · 21. Shin (3) · 22. Tav (3) · 23. Kaf sofit (3) · 24. Mem sofit (3) · 25. Nun sofit (3) · 26. Pe sofit (3) · 27. Tsadi sofit (1)



א א

1. Alef · silent / a tiny glottal stop, like the pause in 'uh-oh' /ʔ/

2 cursive strokes (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /ʔ/

☐ 1 אַבָּא *aba** · dad

☐ 2 אִמָּא *ima** · mom

☐ 3 אָז *az* · so



ב ב

2. Bet · b with a dot (bet), v without (vet) /b ~ v/

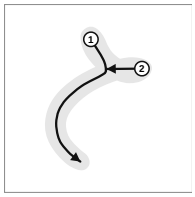
1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /b ~ v/

☐ 1 בֵּית *beit** · house of

☐ 2 בַּבַּיִת *babayit** · in the house

☐ 3 בֶּאֱמֶת *be'emet?* · really?



ג ג

3. Gimel · g as in go /g/

2 cursive strokes (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /g/

ג ג ג ג ג ג ג ג ג ג ג ג

☐ **1** גַּן *gan** · garden

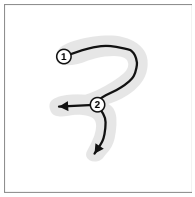
ג ג ג

☐ **2** גֶּשֶׁם *geshem** · rain

גשם גשם גשם

☐ **3** גָּדוֹל *gadol** · big

גדול גדול גדול



ד ד

4. Dalet · d as in door /d/

2 cursive strokes (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /d/

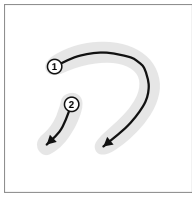
ד ד ד ד ד ד ד ד ד ד ד ד

☐ **1** דַּי *dai* · enough / stop it

די די די

☐ **2** דֶּרֶךְ *derekh** · way

דרך דרך דרך



ה ה

5. He · h as in hat /h/

2 cursive strokes (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /h/

ה ה ה ה ה ה ה ה ה ה ה ה ה ה ה ה ה ה ה ה

☐ **1** הַיּוֹם *hayom* · today

היום היום היום

☐ **2** הֵי *hey* · hi

הי הי הי

☐ **3** הַזָּן *hazan** · who feeds

הזן הזן הזן



ו ו

6. Vav · v as in van /v/

1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /v/

ו ו

☐ **1** וָואלָה *wallah* · really? / wow / honestly

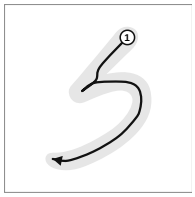
וואלה וואלה וואלה

☐ **2** וָעַד *va'ed** · and ever

ועד ועד ועד

☐ **3** וְאֲנִי *ve'ani** · and I

ואני ואני ואני



ז ז

7. Zayin · z as in zoo /z/

1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /z/

ז ז ז ז ז ז ז ז ז ז ז ז ז ז

☐ **1** זָהָב *zahav** · gold

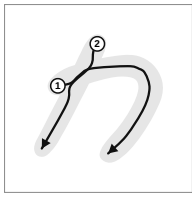
זהב זהב זהב

☐ **2** זֶה *zeh** · this

זה זה זה

☐ **3** זוֹל *zol** · cheap

זול זול זול



ח ח

8. Chet · throaty ch, like Bach /χ/

2 cursive strokes (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /χ/

ח ח ח ח ח ח ח ח ח ח ח ח ח ח

☐ **1** חֲצִי *chetsi* · half

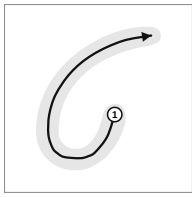
חצי חצי חצי

☐ **2** חָבֵר *chaver* · friend

חבר חבר חבר

☐ **3** חוּמוּס *humus* · hummus

חומוס חומוס חומוס



ט ט

9. Tet · t as in top /t/

1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /t/

ט ט ט ט ט ט ט ט ט ט ט ט ט ט

☐ **1** טוֹב *tov* · OK / well / good

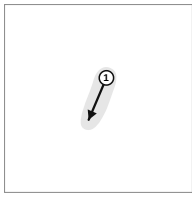
טוב טוב טוב

☐ **2** טֹבוּ *tovu** · good are

טבו טבו טבו

☐ **3** טַל *tal** · dew

טל טל טל



י י

10. Yod · y as in yes /j/

1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /j/

י י י י י י י י י י י י י י

☐ **1** יָמִינָה *yamina* · right

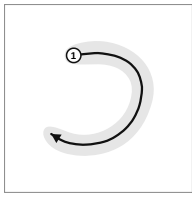
ימינה ימינה ימינה

☐ **2** יֶלֶד *yeled** · boy; child

ילד ילד ילד

☐ **3** יַיִן *yayin* · wine

יין יין יין



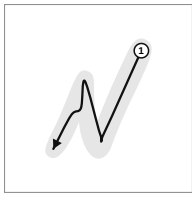
כ כ

11. Kaf · k with a dot (kaf), throaty ch without (khaf) /k ~ χ/

1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /k ~ χ/

כ כ כ



מ מ

13. Mem · m as in map /m/

1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /m/

☐ **1** מַיִם *mayim* · water

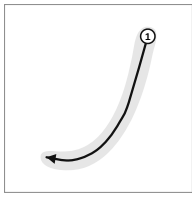
מים מים מים

☐ **2** מֶלֶךְ *melekh** · king

מלך מלך מלך

☐ **3** מִשְׁפָּחָה *mishpachah** · family

משפחה משפחה משפחה



נ נ

14. Nun · n as in net /n/

1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /n/

☐ **1** נְסִיעָה *nesi'ah** · ride; trip

נסיעה נסיעה נסיעה

☐ **2** נוּ *nu* · well? / come on

נו נו נו

☐ **3** נָכוֹן *nachon* · right / correct

נכון נכון נכון



ס ס

15. Samekh · s as in sun /s/

1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /s/

ס ס ס ס ס ס ס ס ס ס ס ס

☐ **1** סָלָט *salat* · salad

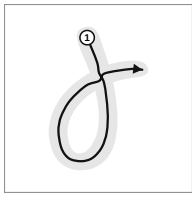
סלט סלט סלט

☐ **2** סֵפֶר *sefer** · book

ספר ספר ספר

☐ **3** סִדּוּר *sidur** · prayer book

סדור סדור סדור



ע ע

16. Ayin · silent in modern Israeli Hebrew (like alef) /ʔ/

1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /ʔ/

ע ע ע ע ע ע ע ע ע ע ע ע

☐ **1** עֶזְרָה *ezra!* · help!

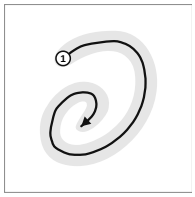
עזרה עזרה עזרה

☐ **2** עֲשָׂרָה *asara* · ten (10)

עשרה עשרה עשרה

☐ **3** עֶשְׂרִים *esrim* · twenty (20)

עשרים עשרים עשרים



פ ף

17. Pe · p with a dot (pe), f without (fe) /p ~ f/

1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /p ~ f/

ף ף ף ף ף ף ף ף ף ף ף ף

☐ **1** פִּיתָה *pita* · pita bread

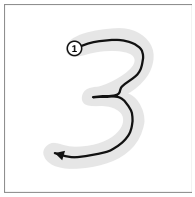
פיתה פיתה פיתה

☐ **2** פָּתוּחַ *patuach* · open

פתוח פתוח פתוח

☐ **3** פָּלָאפֶל *falafel* · falafel

פלאפל פלאפל פלאפל



צ 3

18. Tsadi · ts as in cats /ts/

1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /ts/

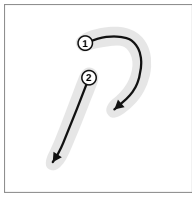
3 3 3 3 3 3 3 3 3 3 3 3

☐ **1** צֶדֶק *tzedek** · justice

צדק צדק צדק

☐ **2** צְדָקָה *tzedakah** · charity; justice

צדקה צדקה צדקה



ק ק

19. Qof · k as in kite /k/

2 cursive strokes (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /k/

ק ק ק ק ק ק ק ק ק ק ק ק ק ק ק

☐ **1** קוֹל *kol** · voice

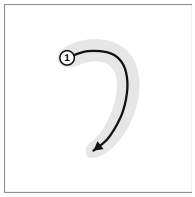
קול קול קול

☐ **2** קָפֶה *kafeh** · coffee

קפה קפה קפה

☐ **3** קַר *kar** · cold

קר קר קר



ר ר

20. Resh · back-of-throat r, like French r /ʁ/

1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /ʁ/

ר ר ר ר ר ר ר ר ר ר ר ר ר ר ר

☐ **1** רֹאשׁ *rosh** · head

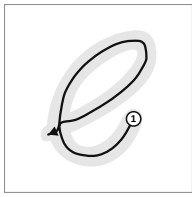
ראש ראש ראש

☐ **2** רַכֶּבֶת *rakevet** · train

רכבת רכבת רכבת

☐ **3** רֶגַע *rega* · one moment

רגע רגע רגע



ש ש

21. Shin · sh as in ship (sin, dot on the left, is s) /ʃ/

1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /ʃ/

ש ש ש ש ש ש ש ש ש ש ש ש

☐ **1** שָׁלוֹם *shalom* · hello / goodbye / peace

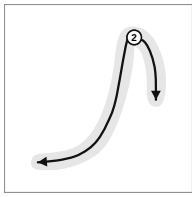
שלום שלום שלום

☐ **2** שֶׁמֶשׁ *shemesh** · sun

שמש שמש שמש

☐ **3** שְׂמֹאלָה *smola* · left

שמאלה שמאלה שמאלה



ת ת

22. Tav · t as in top /t/

2 cursive strokes (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /t/

ת ת ת ת ת ת ת ת ת ת ת ת

☐ **1** תּוֹדָה *toda* · thank you

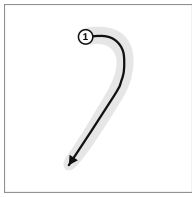
תודה תודה תודה

☐ **2** תּוֹרָה *torah** · Torah

תורה תורה תורה

☐ **3** תֵּשַׁע *tish'a* · nine (9)

תשעה תשעה תשעה



ך ך

23. Kaf sofit · same as kaf, only at the end of a word /k ~ χ/

1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /k ~ χ/

ך ך ך ך ך ך ך ך ך ך ך ך ך

☐ **1** מֶלֶךְ *melekh** · king

מלך מלך מלך

☐ **2** דֶּרֶךְ *derekh** · way

דרך דרך דרך

☐ **3** לַמֶּלֶךְ *lamelekh** · to the king

למלך למלך למלך



ם ם

24. Mem sofit · same as mem, only at the end of a word /m/

1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /m/

ם ם ם ם ם ם ם ם ם ם ם ם ם ם

☐ **1** מַיִם *mayim* · water

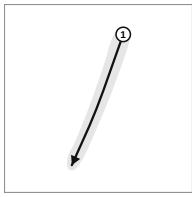
מים מים מים

☐ **2** שָׁלוֹם *shalom* · hello / goodbye / peace

שלום שלום שלום

☐ **3** הַיּוֹם *hayom* · today

היום היום היום



ן /

25. Nun sofit · same as nun, only at the end of a word /n/

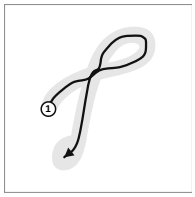
1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /n/

☐ **1** יַיִן *yayin* · wine

☐ **2** בֵּן *ben** · son

☐ **3** גַּן *gan** · garden



ף /

26. Pe sofit · same as pe, only at the end of a word /p ~ f/

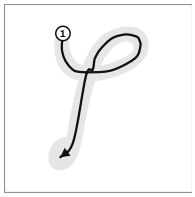
1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /p ~ f/

☐ **1** אֶלֶף *elef* · one thousand (1000)

☐ **2** עוֹדֵף *odef** · change

☐ **3** אַף *af** · also; nose



ץ ץ

27. Tsadi sofit · same as tsadi, only at the end of a word /ts/

1 cursive stroke (draft); print form on the left, handwritten form on the right.

☐ Write the letter /ts/

☐ **1** אֶרֶץ *eretz** · land